

The irruption theory: How mind and matter meet along the route to consciousness

An interview with
Tom Froese

By Matthieu Koroma

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Abstract

In this interview, Tom Froese and Matthieu Koroma address the irruption theory, an account of how mental actions manifest themselves as unexplained variability in brain and bodily activity. We discuss how this approach can be applied to trace back consciousness in (neuro)physiological signatures such as scale free activity and informational complexity. We highlight the study of altered states of consciousness as an opportunity to disentangle the physiological correlates of consciousness from agency. We conclude by addressing how irruption theory provides insights into the therapeutic effects of psychedelics and the importance of crafting an appropriate context to consciously shape agency and behavior.

Keywords: *irruption theory, agency, free-will, volition, consciousness, psychedelics*

With your team, the Embodied Cognitive Science Unit at the Okinawa Institute of Science and Technology Graduate University (OIST, Japan), you develop an approach of the mind drawing on theories and methodologies from philosophy, physical science, computational modeling, neuroscience and psychology. What is the importance for you of interdisciplinarity in the study of the mind and how is it enacted in the research practice of your team?